REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE Q

Measure Q promises strict accountability, but Richmond's own records show that the City bent the rules to put it on the ballot.

Before asking voters to approve $120 million in new debt, city staff bypassed their own procurement rules.

Records show SCI Consulting Group performed roughly $97,000 of "Phase 1" polling and feasibility work, including a taxpayer-funded poll fielded May 12-29, 2026, **before** the City Council approved the **sole-source** contract covering that work.

The sole-source justification was dated April 16, 2026, yet wasn't brought to Council for approval until the June 16 consent calendar, with a contract start date **backdated** to April 28. A second phase adds $150,000 for "informational and ballot-readiness services," bringing the contract to $247,000 without fixing anything at a fire station.

The City has known for years that its fire stations need repair, yet rather than opening the consulting work to competitive bid through a standard RFQ/RFP process, a step that could have saved taxpayers money, staff chose a single, sole-source vendor without prior Council approval. If they can't follow their own rules asking for money, why trust them spending it?

While Measure Q authorizes $120 million in bonds, it puts taxpayers on the hook for **repayments estimated at $249,749,206**. That falls on top of the school bonds and parcel taxes Richmond property owners already pay, including $52 a year for a hospital that closed in 2015.

Vote NO on Measure Q.

The undersigned proponent(s) or author(s) of the Rebuttal to the Argument In Favor of Measure Q at the General Election for Contra Costa County, to be held on 11/3/26, hereby state this argument is true and correct to the best of (his/her/their) knowledge and belief.

1. Name, Title: **Marc Joffe**, President, Contra Costa Taxpayers Association

   Signature: _____

2. Name, Title: **Denise Gianni,** Richmond Resident

   Signature: _____

3. Name, Title: _____

   Signature: _____

4. Name, Title: _____

   Signature: _____